

ICS Activation Checklist — Food & Water-borne Illness Outbreak

Printable version of the on-screen checklist for the Food & Water-borne Illness Outbreak scenario. NEW form — added to close the A-code gap identified for Section 8.11.

Time	Step	Actions	Lead / support	Confirmations
First report	Step 1 — Spot the pattern	- Two or more guests or team members with similar symptoms (vomiting, diarrhoea, cramps, fever) in a short window is the trigger — treat as a possible outbreak, not isolated illness. - Report to IC at once: "Code Outbreak — [number affected] — [symptoms]."	1st Responder / Any Team Member / Medic	☐ IC alerted · pattern logged
Within 15 min	Step 2 — Activate ICS	- IC starts the team; assigns OC, LC, Medic, EC. - EC opens the Symptom Tracking Log (A41) and begins logging every affected person. - IC notifies Head Office.	IC / EC	☐ ICT/ERT activated · Symptom log open · HO notified
15-30 min	Step 3 — Contain the source	- Stop serving the suspected meal, dish, or water source; hold back remaining stock — do not dispose of it. - Kitchen HOD pulls the Kitchen Menu & Batch Log (A45) to identify what was served. - If water is suspected, switch to bottled or confirmed-safe water for all prep, drinking, and ice.	OC / Kitchen HOD / LC	☐ Suspected source stopped · stock retained
30-60 min	Step 4 — Care for those affected	- Medic checks each affected person, watching for dehydration. - Offer oral rehydration solution or clean water in small, frequent sips. - Anyone with high fever, blood in vomit/stool, severe dehydration, or non-improving symptoms needs medical evacuation — follow the Medical Emergency checklist (A18) and Medevac Required Information (A6).	Medic / Responders	☐ Affected persons assessed · evac triggered if needed
1-2 hrs	Step 5 — Deep clean & isolate the risk	- Deep clean and sanitise the kitchen, prep surfaces, and any implicated water points. - Any unwell team member — especially kitchen/food service staff — comes off duty until fully recovered. - Retain samples of the suspected food or water source, refrigerated and labelled.	Kitchen HOD / Housekeeping HOD / LC	☐ Area cleaned · unwell staff off duty · samples retained
2-4 hrs	Step 6 — Communicate with guests	- Inform unaffected guests calmly of what is being done, without causing alarm. - Any guest communication about cause or scale goes through the IC only.	IC / EC	☐ Guests briefed · comms through IC only
Within 24 hrs	Step 7 — Debrief & reporting	- IC leads a debrief within 2 hours of the situation stabilising. - EC submits the Outbreak Incident Report (A14) to Head Office within 24 hours. - Review food storage, water treatment, and hygiene procedures with kitchen and housekeeping HODs.	IC / EC	☐ Debrief held · report filed · procedures reviewed